

Language development 1

Past simple and present perfect

Summer Camp Jobs

IN CALIFORNIA

- Spanish-Speaking Counselors required.
- Good English essential.
- Must be fun-loving, patient and concerned for the welfare of young people.



- 1 a Read the advert and the extract from Isabel's letter of application. Is she a good candidate? Why?



My first language is Spanish. However, I have often been to California to visit my American friends and I have learned a lot of English over the years. Last year I spent two months on an internship program in San Francisco. Although I haven't worked at a summer camp before, two years ago I helped at a children's charity here in Peru for a month.

Spelling note:

program (American English);
programme (British English)

- b Underline examples of the past simple and circle examples of the present perfect simple in Isabel's letter.
- c Answer these questions.
- Do we know exactly when she:
- visited friends in the USA?
 - learned English?
 - was on an internship program?
 - helped at a children's charity?

- d Complete this box with examples from Isabel's letter.

- A The present perfect simple expresses experience; actions and situations at an unspecified time in the past.

EXAMPLES:

- 1
2
3

- B The past simple expresses actions at a specified time in the past.

EXAMPLES:

- 1
2

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- 2 a Complete these extracts from a job interview. Use the correct form of the past simple or the present perfect simple.

- 1 A: (you/live abroad?)
B: (Yes)
A: (Where/live?)
B: In Dublin.
A: (When/go there?)
B: In 2002.
- 2 A: (you/work in an office?)
B: (No)
- 3 A: (you/ever go to/the USA?)
B: (Yes)
A: (When/go there?)
B: Last year.
A: (Why/go there?)
B: To study English.
- 4 A: (you/use English in your work before?)
B: (No)

- b Ask each other the questions in Exercise 2a, and give answers which are true for you.

Present perfect simple and continuous

3 a Read the next part of Isabel's letter.

I have lived in Lima since 2006. I have been studying for a degree in education for two years and I have just taken my second-year exams, though I haven't had the results yet. Recently, I have been taking part in a series of workshops on children's games, which I find very interesting.

b Underline examples of the present perfect simple and circle examples of the continuous in Isabel's letter.

c Answer these questions.

- Does Isabel live in Lima now?
- Is she still studying for a degree?
- Which is more permanent, 1 or 2?
- Has she finished her exams?
- Has she finished taking part in the workshops?

d Complete the box with examples from Isabel's letter.

- A The present perfect simple expresses more **permanent** actions or states which started in the past and continue to the present.
EXAMPLE:
- B The present perfect continuous expresses more **temporary** actions or states which started in the past and continue to the present.
EXAMPLE:
- C The present perfect simple expresses **recent finished actions** including repeated actions.
EXAMPLE:
- D The present perfect continuous expresses **recent longer activities**, which may not be finished.
EXAMPLE:

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e Look at the box and complete the phrases with *for* or *since*.*for* or *since*?

Use *for* with a period of time, and *since* with a point in time:

for two years *since* 1990

- | | |
|---------------------|----------------------|
| 1 ages | 4 six o'clock |
| 2 my birthday | 5 half an hour |
| 3 a long time | 6 I was born |

4 Tick (✓) the correct sentences. Correct the wrong ones.

- Sorry we're late. We've been sitting in traffic.
- I've been having some good news. I've got the job!
- Marta's been taking exams all week. She's exhausted.
- I've read that book. Do you want it back?
- Emma's been falling over and hurt her knee.
- The lift isn't working so we've used the stairs all day.

5 a Complete the extract from a letter with the correct form of the verbs in brackets: past simple, present perfect simple or continuous.

I (1) (be) here for two months now and (2) (not write) to you yet. Sorry! I hope you (3) (not wait) for a letter. I (4) (work) a lot and I (5) (not have) much free time. At first I (6) (feel) a bit lonely, but recently I (7) (make) some friends. I (8) (try) to find somewhere to live for weeks and I think I (9) (find) a flat at last. Up to now I (10) (stay) with a colleague.

b Complete these sentences about yourself.

- I've written ...
- I've never ...
- I've ... since ...
- I've been ...ing ... this year.
- I haven't ... this month.

6 Find and correct the eight mistakes in this piece of writing.

I have been born in Peru 26 years ago and I've lived here all my life. I am married for two years but we don't have any children yet. I've been working in a bank since four years and I enjoy it a lot. In my spare time I'm trying to improve my English - I've had private lessons since six months. I also love reading. Last year I have tried to read a novel in English. I go to the mountains for my holidays during six years because I love walking. I've also gone to Brazil two years ago to stay with some friends.